

School Homework Helper

Live Deployment Guide

Domain: www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com

Stack: Next.js 15 + Supabase + OpenAI

Hosting: Vercel (recommended) + Bluehost DNS

Date: June 2026

Important: Read This First

This website is built with Next.js 15, which requires Node.js hosting. It cannot run on standard PHP-only shared hosting without Node.js support.

Most Bluehost shared cPanel plans are PHP-focused. Before deploying on Bluehost directly, check your cPanel for Setup Node.js App, Node.js Selector, SSH with Node, or a VPS/Cloud plan.

RECOMMENDED: Deploy on Vercel (free tier works well for Next.js) and point your Bluehost domain DNS to Vercel. You keep your domain at Bluehost; Vercel hosts the app.

What You Need Before Going Live

Accounts and services

- GitHub account - store code for deployment
- Vercel account (recommended) - host Next.js app
- Bluehost cPanel - manage domain DNS
- Supabase project - authentication and database
- OpenAI API key - AI tools
- Google Cloud Console - Google Sign-In OAuth
- Google AdSense (optional) - advertisements

Environment variables (production)

Set these in Vercel: Settings > Environment Variables. Never commit real keys to GitHub.

- OPENAI_API_KEY - your OpenAI secret key
- OPENAI_MODEL - gpt-4o-mini (optional)
- NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL - <https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com>
- NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL - <https://xxxxx.supabase.co>
- NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY - Supabase public anon key
- SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY - server only; keep secret
- NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_CLIENT_ID - optional, ca-pub-...
- NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_SLOT - optional
- NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_SLOT_HORIZONTAL - optional
- NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_SLOT_IN_ARTICLE - optional

Supabase setup

- Log in to supabase.com and open your project
- SQL Editor: run supabase/schema.sql from this project
- Authentication > Providers > Google: Enable
- URL Configuration - add redirect URLs:
- https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com/**
- https://schoolhomeworkhelper.com/**
- http://localhost:3000/** (local dev)
- Copy Project URL, anon key, and service_role key for env vars

Google OAuth (Sign-In)

- Google Cloud Console > APIs & Services > Credentials
- Create OAuth 2.0 Web application credentials
- Authorized JavaScript origins:
- https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- https://schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Authorized redirect URI: Supabase callback URL
- https://YOUR_PROJECT.supabase.co/auth/v1/callback
- Paste Client ID and Secret into Supabase Google provider

Option A - Recommended: Vercel + Bluehost Domain

Step 1: Push code to GitHub

- Create a new GitHub repository
- Ensure .env.local is in .gitignore and never pushed

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/school-homework-helper.git
git push -u origin main
```

Step 2: Import project on Vercel

- Go to vercel.com and sign in with GitHub
- Add New > Project > Import your repository
- Framework: Next.js (auto-detected)
- Add all environment variables from the list above
- Set NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL to https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Click Deploy and wait for build to finish

Step 3: Add custom domain in Vercel

- Vercel project > Settings > Domains
- Add: schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Add: www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Note the DNS records Vercel shows

Step 4: Configure DNS in Bluehost cPanel

- Bluehost > cPanel > Domains > Zone Editor
- Select schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Add or update DNS records:
- A record | Host @ | Value 76.76.21.21
- CNAME record | Host www | Value cname.vercel-dns.com
- Remove conflicting A/CNAME records for @ or www
- Save changes

Step 5: Wait for DNS and SSL

- DNS propagation: 15 minutes to 48 hours (often under 1 hour)
- Vercel automatically provisions HTTPS (SSL)
- Set www as primary domain or redirect apex to www in Vercel

Step 6: Verify live site checklist

- Homepage loads at https://www.schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Logo, navigation, and footer display correctly
- Cookie banner appears; Accept/Reject works
- All 6 AI tools respond
- Google Sign-In works on /signin

- Privacy, Terms, and Cookie pages load
- Mobile layout looks correct on phone

Step 7: Future updates

- Commit and push to GitHub main branch
- Vercel auto-redeploys when connected to GitHub

Option B - Deploy on Bluehost (Node.js required)

Use only if your Bluehost plan includes Node.js App setup or SSH with persistent Node.

Step 1: Confirm Node.js support

- In cPanel, look for Setup Node.js App
- Contact Bluehost support to confirm Node 18+ is available

Step 2: Upload project

- SSH: git clone https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/school-homework-helper.git
- Or upload ZIP via File Manager and extract

Step 3: Install and build

```
npm install
npm run build
```

Create .env or set env vars in cPanel Node app panel.

Step 4: Configure Node.js app in cPanel

- Setup Node.js App > Create Application
- Node version: 18 or 20
- Application root: your project folder
- Startup: npm start (runs next start)
- Set all environment variables
- Start the application

Note: Shared hosting often cannot run Next.js reliably. Vercel is strongly recommended.

How Bluehost + Vercel Work Together

- Domain registration: Bluehost
- DNS records: Bluehost cPanel Zone Editor
- Website hosting (Next.js): Vercel
- Database and Auth: Supabase
- AI API: OpenAI

You do NOT need to upload PHP files from the php/ folder if you deploy the Next.js app.

Troubleshooting

Site shows Bluehost default page

- DNS not updated or old A record points to Bluehost server IP
- Wait and verify A/CNAME in Zone Editor

Google Sign-In fails on live site

- Add production URLs in Supabase redirect allow list
- Add origins in Google OAuth console
- Ensure NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL matches live URL exactly

AI tools return errors

- Check OPENAI_API_KEY in Vercel env
- Check OpenAI billing/credits
- View Vercel Functions logs for API route errors

Ads not showing

- AdSense must approve your site first
- User must click Accept on cookie banner
- Verify NEXT_PUBLIC_ADSENSE_CLIENT_ID starts with ca-pub-

Build fails on Vercel

- Run npm run build locally first
- Fix TypeScript/lint errors
- Ensure all env vars are set before deploy

Quick Reference Commands

- Local development: pnpm dev
- Production build test: pnpm run build
- Run production locally: pnpm start
- Lint: pnpm run lint

Support

- Website email: hello@schoolhomeworkhelper.com
- Vercel docs: <https://vercel.com/docs>
- Supabase docs: <https://supabase.com/docs>
- Bluehost support: via Bluehost chat / help center